**Single User Mode**

We have explained how to enter single user mode from LILO and Grub under section 9.1.1 and 9.1.2 respectively. Single user mode comes with lot of responsibility and anyone who uses this mode must understand the freedom that Linux OS bestows on its users. Almost all the commands of Linux system works in single user mode. This mode is normally used by system administrators at to implement certain changes that he/she cant do if users are logged into the system. At home user level this mode can be used to overwrite the password for root and/or users. Use it only when the password is forgotten.

**Hardening Single User Mode:**

Any local user can misuse root privileges to tamper your systems configuration through single user mode. To protect your system from such instances you can either add password to the boot loader Grub or LILO (we have explained how to add password in Grub, 9.1.2). But the advance level of security will be to enable password protection to single user mode wherein anyone who logs into this mode will be asked for root password in order to continue. But, one must now understand that enabling such a security will disable root password recovery method. Your memory power will be the only source of rescue. To harden the single user mode to password protection level you need to edit the **/etc/inittab** file and append a line **'id:S:wait:/sbin/sulogin'**

This will execute **'sulogin'** which will demand root password just before opening the shell prompt (sh-01#) of single user mode.

Remember: Never ever forget the root password!

machines and replace the PCI cards every now and then; so kudzu can be disabled. To disable a process you will have to use ***'chkconfig'*** command repeatedly for every process that needs a change in its status. The complete command is ***#chkconfig --level <levels 3 or 5> <process name> on|off***